

KEITH T. GARNER

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Engineering leader with nearly three decades in software, spanning individual contributor through Director across startups, enterprise SaaS, and a \$6M corporate IT organization. Has built and scaled teams from nine engineers to a 60+ person distributed organization across three continents, developed the managers who ran them, and stayed close enough to the code to be the escalation path when it mattered.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

KGarner Consulting, LLC, Remote

Aug 2026 - Present

Technologies: TypeScript, Node.js, LTI 1.3, OAuth 2.0, OIDC, JWT

Independent Contractor

Founded an independent consultancy delivering principal-level engineering and technical leadership to software companies.

- Engaged by an EdTech startup as principal engineer, owning their LMS integration strategy and the design and implementation of LTI-based integrations.
- Leading a refactor of the client's LTI integration layer, consolidating duplicated per-LMS implementations into a shared foundation and closing security gaps across the integration surface.
- Advise the client's head of engineering on team and delivery practices.

SUBSCRIBE, Remote

Oct 2025 - Mar 2026

Technologies: Ruby on Rails, React, PostgreSQL, AWS

Director of Software Engineering

Reporting to the CTO, led a distributed engineering organization of 60+ engineers across 10 teams spread across the US, LATAM, and Europe.

- Turned around two underperforming team leads and established structured growth paths for all 10 leads in the organization.
- Rebuilt the engineering interview process around consistent evaluation criteria, addressing wide variance in how hiring teams assessed candidates.
- Partnered with the CISO and led a 2-engineer working group to implement Snyk, advancing the organization's ISO 27001 certification readiness.

Instructure, Chicago, IL, Remote

July 2015 - Sept 2025

Technologies: Ruby on Rails, React, GraphQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, AWS

Principal Engineering Manager - Canvas

Jan 2025 - Sept 2025

Founded and led the Growth Engineering team, assembled from existing Canvas engineers to drive revenue-focused initiatives. Team was subsequently tasked with a high-priority security remediation effort, delivering critical fixes across the Canvas codebase.

- Coordinated cross-functionally with service-owning engineering teams and the Customer Success organization to communicate upcoming API changes, ensuring alignment across technical and customer-facing stakeholders.

Principal Engineer - Canvas

Dec 2023 - Jan 2025

Served as a senior technical leader across the Canvas organization, driving cross-team initiatives, building engineering onboarding programs during a major international hiring expansion, and owning executive-level customer escalations tied to new sales and at-risk accounts.

- Authored and delivered the company's new engineering onboarding program supporting a major international hiring surge, including Canvas-specific technical onboarding presented in person in Budapest.

- Designated technical lead for high-priority customer escalations tied to securing new business and retaining at-risk accounts, partnering directly with Sales and Solutions Engineering.
- Led a cross-product effort to pre-populate demo environments, saving the Solutions Engineering team days of manual work per cycle.
- Drove performance and cost work across multiple projects, including query optimization that reduced IOPS costs and hands-on optimization that retained customers struggling with large data sets.

Engineering Director - Canvas

Mar 2021 - Dec 2023

Led five Canvas/edu teams totaling 42 engineers across the United States, Latin America, and Hungary, including a contractor team built from scratch to offload critical services maintenance and free up feature team capacity.

- Led the effort to enhance and refine the bi-annual employee assessment process, resulting in a more precise and consistent experience for Engineering Managers conducting reviews and improved feedback for those being evaluated.
- Led the engineering component of the annual intern recruitment process, yielding multiple classes of high-performing interns with a 70% hire-to-FTE conversion rate.
- Guided engineering managers to achieve a quarterly delivery rate of 90% for committed projects.
- Actively participated in hiring at all levels of the engineering organization, from individual contributors to engineering managers, contributing to team growth across three geographic regions.

Engineering Manager - Canvas Feature Teams

Sept 2018 - Mar 2021

Led four Canvas feature teams totaling 24 engineers, directly managing three team leads and three individual contributors while providing oversight across the full organization.

Team Lead, Engineering

Sept 2015 - Sept 2018

Led a 9-engineer team across the Chicago office, Salt Lake City office, and remote locations. Operated as a hands-on player/coach, actively contributing to the codebase while representing the company externally at job fairs, meetups, and recruiting events as a speaker and engineering ambassador.

- Partnered with the Product Manager to drive open bug count from 50 down to below 5 and maintained that standard going forward.
- Delivered a major gradebook overhaul ahead of the company's annual conference, shipping key features including a rewritten grade release function, late and missing grade policies, persistent sorting and filtering, and anonymous and moderated grading.
- Enhanced team productivity by 35% through the introduction of weekly metrics and targeted one-on-one discussions to identify and address impediments.

Senior Software Engineer, Engineering

July 2015 - Sept 2015

Independent contributor on the Gradebook team for the Canvas learning management system. Promoted to Team Lead within two months based on demonstrated leadership skills and a rapid reputation for solving complex and long-standing technical problems.

National Association of REALTORS®, Chicago, IL

Sept 2008 - May 2015

Vice President, Information Technology Services

Led the day-to-day operations and future development of the Information Technology department with a \$6 million budget and a team of 25 personnel based in Chicago and Washington, DC. The environment encompassed servers, databases, telephony, and user endpoint devices.

- Rebuilt the NAR E-Commerce Payment Gateway within six weeks, successfully passing a Level 1 PCI Audit upon completion.
- Led the migration of 400+ servers to a virtualized environment, reducing hardware costs, maintenance overhead, and improving redundancy.

- Mentored the Managing Director of Application Development, driving the project queue from several months behind schedule to consistent on-time delivery.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

National Association of REALTORS® , Chicago, IL Center for REALTOR® Technology — Managing Director (2006-2008); Strategic Architect and founding member (2001-2006)	2001 - 2008
The Net Squad , Oakbrook, IL Internet Solutions Architect, Principal	2000 - 2001
Resource Information Management Systems (RIMS) , Naperville, IL Manager of Technical Architecture	1999 - 2000
Strategic Technology Resources (STR) , Chicago, IL Consultant	1997 - 1999

OPEN SOURCE

github.com/ktgeek

- **supreSSHion** — macOS menu bar agent in Swift that unloads SSH keys from ssh-agent on screen lock or sleep, narrowing the window an unattended machine can be used to reach remote systems.
- **bluld** — Linux daemon in C that exposes Blinkstick USB HID devices through the kernel LED class, making them controllable as standard LEDs on x86 OpenWRT routers.
- **ezRETS** — Led development of an open-source cross-platform ODBC driver for RETS real estate data, supported on Windows, Linux, and macOS.
- **libRETS** — Contributor to the C++ client library underpinning RETS access across the real estate industry.

PUBLICATIONS

- “Large-Scale Mail with Postfix, OpenLDAP and Courier” — Linux Journal, 2003
- “Using the Encap Package Management System to Manage Non-System Packages” — Linux Journal, 2003

EDUCATION

University of Illinois, Urbana, IL
B.S. in Computer Science, College of Engineering